PRODUCT CASE STUDY · ORDER-TO-CASH · RUPAK GHANPATHI

# Every rupee needs an owner.

When a distributor short-pays, the gap can bounce between AR, Sales and Finance over email before anyone closes it. This is the exception workflow I'd build to fix it, designed from Cello World's public filings.

**+14.0%**
Trade receivables, ₹658 Cr → ₹750 Cr (FY26)

**+8.8%**
Revenue, ₹2,136 Cr → ₹2,324 Cr

**~₹34 Cr**
₹658 Cr grown at 8.8% ≈ ₹716 Cr; actual ₹750 Cr. An estimate, not a measured backlog

> **Why it matters:** that's working capital the business can't use. And while a deduction sits parked in an email thread, the distributor's account can look settled enough to keep ordering on credit.

## THE SAME ₹20,000 GAP, TWO WORKFLOWS

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| TODAY (LIKELY) | **Pays ₹9.8 L** on a ₹10 L invoice<br>No breakdown | → **AR can't match** parks the gap<br>No reason code | → **Emails Sales** for scheme proof<br>Unclear owner | → **Email approval** Controller signs off<br>Weak audit trail | → **Posted in ERP** ageing at close<br>Late visibility |
| PROPOSED | **Auto-match** exact reference and amount | → **Case opens** mandatory reason code | → **Routed owner** Finance or Sales, with SLA | → **Maker-checker** above Finance threshold | → **Recorded in ERP** approved outcome; case history kept |

## DESIGN DECISIONS, AND WHAT THEY COST

1. **Control before speed.** The MVP fixes ownership and approvals first. A faster process with no owner just moves the backlog.
2. **Strict matching at launch.** A lower auto-match rate, in exchange for zero wrong matches, which cost far more to unwind.
3. **The ERP stays the system of record.** A lightweight layer (proposed: ServiceNow case management) records only approved outcomes in the ERP; the integration is a proposal to confirm with IT.
4. **No automatic write-offs.** Anything above a Finance-set tolerance needs a person to close it.

## MVP STORIES → ACCEPTANCE CHECKS

| User story | Acceptance check |
|---|---|
| Auto-match exact reference + amount | Matched, labelled and logged |
| Every gap opens a case | Can't close without a reason code |
| Route by reason (scheme → Sales) | Owner and SLA timer set on creation |
| Maker-checker above threshold | When the maker approves, it's blocked, logged and sent to a checker |

### Validate before building

Five interviews (AR executive, AR lead, Controller, area sales manager, ERP owner) and one month of receipts. If gaps are rare or close fast, stop and redirect.

### Measure in the pilot

Auto-match rate by value · median days to resolve · value aged over 30 days · zero wrong matches. One division; targets set from the baseline.

### Controls and UAT

Audit trail per case · self-approval blocked · SLA breach escalates. Given/When/Then cases for splits, duplicates and no-reference receipts.

**Skills shown:** problem framing · stakeholder analysis · process design · user stories and acceptance criteria · controls and UAT · success metrics

Self-initiated case study from Cello World Ltd's public filings (FY26 consolidated, FY25 restated). Internal processes are hypotheses, not confirmed company practice. Full case study and deck available on request.